



WEAPONS OF MASS DISTRACTION

We take a look at a very select bunch of laptops aimed at a very select bunch of people – gamers on the go. Whether it's bling you're after or a pure gaming experience, these bad boys aim to please...

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Gaming laptops are a very niche product category, and will perhaps remain so. In recent times, gaming notebooks are being preferred over gaming desktops for a number of reasons. They need less space, can be set up anywhere and are portable. They're also cool, with fancy lights, backlit keyboards and other bling. In India, some

consider them status symbols and judging by the number of BMWs on our roads that's all the reason some folks need to buy one.

There are four companies engaged in supplying gaming laptops in India – Alienware (Dell), MSI, HP and ASUS. HP as a policy doesn't participate in comparison tests, and didn't send us units for evaluation.

NOTEBOOKS UNDER A LAKH

Quite surprisingly, there wasn't a huge difference in components

inside these notebooks and the ones costing over a lakh. The major difference between these notebooks and the costlier ones is mainly the build quality and bling factor. The costlier notebooks inevitably look a little more upmarket, although not

the two MSI lookalikes – the GX660 and GT680R.

MSI GE620: ₹59,999

The GE620 was the slimmest notebook in this comparison, not that any of them could be called slim. Its lid sports a brushed metal finish, while the inner portion of the lid that forms the bezel is plastic, and not of the best quality, although it looks fairly sturdy. The palmrest and remainder of the body also have a brushed metal finish. There are no flashing lights here.

Unlike the GX780R and GX660 that have more key travel and softer feedback from the keypad, the GE620 has a slightly harder keypad and



MSI GE620